

Final Course Checklist

Here is a checklist that considers the end-to-end process from job search to job offer or rejection. In addition, this checklist allows you to evaluate your readiness for a job search and develop an action plan to achieve your goals.

Part I: Assessing your skills and the job market

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Did you inventory your skills and compare them with the NICE Framework? Do you have a plan to improve your skills?		
2. Have you identified cybersecurity employment opportunities in your area?		
3. Are there certifications in cybersecurity you want to pursue?		
4. Did you develop a professional portfolio? Did you request feedback from friends and associates?		
5. Did you create an online profile on LinkedIn and other applicable online sites?		
6. Did you create an elevator pitch? Did you practice the pitch with friends and associates?		

Part II: Initiating the job search

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Did you decide which industries and companies you want to target?		
2. Have you researched job postings on multiple sites? Have you prioritized your choices?		
3. Have you researched multiple companies and job descriptions and not limited your choices?		
4. Are you taking advantage of your online and off-line contacts and networking effectively?		
5. Are you working with third-party recruiters? Are they adding value? Are roles well-defined?		

Part III: Resume and application development

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Did you select a template for your resume? Does the template allow the interviewer to effectively search?		
2. Have you identified friends and professionals willing to act as references for you?		
3. Have you tailored your resume to meet the needs of individual job positions?		
4. Did you draft an effective cover letter? Is your cover letter personalized?		
5. Have you inventoried the required documentation and attachments necessary to submit your application?		
6. Have you validated all employment submission requirements with the hiring manager?		
7. Did you complete any initial take home assignments that were assigned?		

Part IV: Interview preparation

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Have you identified the type of job interview you will be given?		
2. Have you prepared and practiced responding to general questions for a first-stage interview?		
3. Are you technically prepared and ready for a virtual interview?		
4. Have you planned logistics to arrive on time for a face-to-face interview?		
5. Did you determine the appropriate dress for the interview?		

Part V: Responding to interview questions

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Have you prepared and practiced responding to technical questions for a technical screening interview?		
2. Are behavioral question responses developed using the STAR method?		
3. Have you prepared and practiced your behavioral question responses?		
4. Have you prepared and practiced responses to industry and job-specific questions?		
5. Are you prepared for a case study or whiteboard interview if applicable?		
6. Are you ready for tough or trick questions? Have you prepared and practiced your responses?		
7. Have you practiced your question responses with a friend or colleague and received feedback?		
8. Have you prepared and practiced the questions you plan to present to the interviewers?		

Part VI: Post interview checklist

Job Search Checklist	Yes/No	My Action Plan
1. Did you take all post-interview actions if you received a job offer?		
2. Did you take all post-interview actions if you did not receive an offer?		
3. Did you perform a retrospective after each interview?		
4. Did you send a thank you note or email within 24 hours of interview completion?		
5. Do you have an action plan to improve your employment potential moving forward?		

